



Figure 1: The first screen after installation

is to Web authoring, Slidifier is to presentation slides. Wikis greatly simplified the creation of Web pages by abstracting the HTML and CSS syntax, thus making the creation of content on the Web child's play. Similarly, Slidifier has simplified creating HTML-based presentations. The best part about Slidifier is that you can convert your 'notes' into 'slides' in no time. You can also create text (*ascii*) content in your mobile (text pad) and paste it into Slidifier, and your slides are ready!

Installing Slidifier

Since Slidifier is LAMP-based software, do ensure you have a working implementation of LAMP such as XAMPP or the equivalent. Visit <http://slidifier.com/> to download the source code of Slidifier into the directory that your server points to (e.g., C:/xampp/htdocs on MS Windows or /var/www/ on any Linux-based system). That is all you need to do to make Slidifier work. Next, open the browser and point to <http://localhost/slidifier/>

Just click the 'Try Slidifier now!' button to get started. You will be taken to some sample presentation content that gives you an overview of the features of Slidifier.

Features

Slidifier is best suited for quick and informal presentations. This is by far the fastest way to create slides. You only need to type the content in plain text and indicate what you want as the heading and the bullet points.

There is an option to choose from the predefined themes designed using style sheets, which are equivalent to *Template* in Microsoft PowerPoint.

You can choose to host the presentation slides on the server by clicking the 'Save' button. This action gives you two URLs that can be used in future. The first URL is for the admin/author to edit the content at a later point. The second is for the viewers of the presentation.

Slides can contain source code that is highlighted in a different block. The lines of code should be enclosed between 'W' lines as shown in the sample presentation.

Navigation of slides is done using the mouse or keyboard. A left-click on the mouse advances the slides forward. You



Figure 2: Slidifier in action

can also use the right arrow key to advance slides or the left arrow key to go backwards. The 'Esc' key will abort the presentation.

The time and slide number is positioned on the top left corner and top right corner of each slide.

Syntax and sample presentations

Now let us look at the syntax used by creating a new presentation.

Slide headings and text: You can specify the heading for each slide by prefixing '#' in front of the text that you want as the heading. A single '#' is equivalent to <H1> in HTML. For the next level of H2 and H3 headings, authors can type '##' and '###', respectively.

```
# Heading 1 (level 1)
## Heading 2 (level 2)
### Heading 3 (level 3)
```

Slide separation: Slides are created by typing text in the large text area of the screen shown in Figure 3. Slides are separated by '---' dashes.

Bullets: Bullets are most frequently used in a slide. You just need to prefix each sentence in the slide with a '-'. Nested bullets can be achieved by adding '-' in front of the bullet.

- Bullet 1
- Bullet 2
- Bullet 3

Including pictures: Pictures can be added to slides by writing HTML one-liners into the slide text. Copy the images you would like to include in the presentation in the *img* directory of the Slidifier code. To include the image (e.g., *taj.png*) insert the text given below:

```

```

You can also adjust the width and height by using the line below:

```

```